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Board of Education Report

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File #: Res-009-23/24, **Version:** 1

Mr. Schmerelson - Dyslexia Awareness Month (Res-009-23/24) (For Action October 17, 2023)

Whereas, Dyslexia is a language-based disability that exists on a continuum and is characterized by difficulties in learning how to read fluently. Students with dyslexia can also experience difficulties with oral language, spelling, writing skills, and math computation. It is estimated that dyslexia affects as many as one in five individuals;

Whereas, Dyslexia contributes to challenges in reading fluency and decoding, meanwhile strengths in higher-level cognitive functions, such as critical thinking, reasoning, and problem-solving;

Whereas, Scientific advancement in understanding dyslexia has improved to know of the neurological and epidemiological basis;

Whereas, Early screening for reading difficulties including dyslexia is critical to ensure individuals receive focused, evidence-based intervention allowing the promotion of self-awareness and self-empowerment and the provision of necessary accommodations to ensure school and life success;

Whereas, In July 2023, Governor Gavin Newsom signed into law SB 114, creating a new requirement in Education Code section 53008 which mandates, starting in the 2025-2026 school year, all kindergarten through 2nd grade California students to be screened for reading difficulties including dyslexia and apply early intervention methods for any student identified at risk for reading difficulties, including difficulties associated with characteristics of dyslexia;

Whereas, The California State Parent Teacher Association (PTA) adopted a resolution at its 2016 annual convention that recognizes dyslexia has significant educational implications that need to be better addressed by public schools and school districts; and

Whereas, The Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District, passed the resolution Recognizing and Addressing the Educational Implications of Dyslexia in LAUSD Schools (Res-101-16/17), which addresses plans to be developed that will 1) ensure policies, procedures, and practices are aligned to the provisions of state legislation program guidelines pursuant to Education Code section 56335 and 2) provide teacher and staff training necessary to improve the understanding of dyslexia and its warning signs, appropriate evidence-based structured literacy instruction, and appropriate classroom accommodations and modifications; now, therefore, be it

Resolved, That the Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District recognizes that dyslexia has significant educational implications that must be addressed, and designates October 2023 as Dyslexia Awareness Month;

Resolved further, That the Board will direct the Superintendent to utilize resources from the Division of Instruction to conduct community outreach regarding the State's mandate to screen for reading

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difficulties including dyslexia; and, be it finally

Resolved, That the Parent Center will dedicate the month of October to educate parents by dispelling the myths of dyslexia and ensuring that students receive the services and support they need to learn to read.